

Before Saturday: what to set up and bring

The Travel Advisor's AI Playbook, Saturday September 19, 8:00 AM to 12:00 PM Eastern, live on Zoom.

This is a working session. You will type, build, and save things on your own laptop for most of the morning, so the setup below matters more than it would for a webinar. Everything on this list is free. None of it asks for a credit card. Budget about twenty minutes, ideally by Thursday so there is time to ask us if anything goes wrong.

Questions: support@empowerment-ai.com.

1. Your AI account (required)

Make one of these. Make both if you have ten spare minutes; free accounts have usage limits, and having a second one means you never sit idle if you hit a cap mid-session.

Free ChatGPT account (about 2 minutes)

1. Go to chatgpt.com in your browser.
2. Click Sign up. Use your email, or sign in with Google or Apple.
3. Confirm the email if asked. You may be asked for a phone number for verification.
4. When you see the empty chat box, type "hello" and press Enter. If you get a reply, you are done.
5. Stay signed in on the laptop you will use Saturday.

Free Claude account (about 2 minutes)

1. Go to claude.ai.
2. Click Sign up. Use your email or Google.
3. Confirm the email if asked.
4. Type "hello" in the chat box. If you get a reply, you are done.
5. Stay signed in on the laptop you will use Saturday.

Neither account asks for payment. If a page offers you a paid plan, close it. Nothing we do on Saturday needs one.

One privacy setting, worth doing now

Both tools can use what you type to improve their models unless you turn that off. Thirty seconds each:

- ChatGPT: click your name or the gear, Settings, Data controls, turn off "Improve the model for everyone."

- Claude: Settings, Privacy, turn off the model improvement option.

We will also teach you the habit that matters more than any setting: never paste a client's name, passport number, date of birth, address, or payment details into any AI tool. The trip details are enough.

2. Zoom (required)

Use the Zoom desktop app, not the browser version. The browser version hides some of what we use (polls, breakout rooms, some chat features).

1. Download or update it at zoom.us/download. Choose "Zoom Workplace" for desktop.
2. Open it once and sign in or continue as a guest.
3. Test your sound: Settings (gear), Audio, "Test Speaker" and "Test Mic."
4. Test your camera: Settings, Video. Cameras are welcome and not required.

Your join link and passcode arrive by email on Friday. They will not be posted anywhere public.

3. Two screens, if you can manage it (strongly recommended)

You will be watching our screen and typing on your own at the same time. One screen means constant switching. Any of these work:

- A second monitor, with Zoom on one and your AI tool on the other.
 - A tablet or phone for Zoom, and your laptop for the AI tool. Join Zoom on the phone with the Zoom app, mute the phone's mic if you also join from the laptop, or just use the phone for video and the laptop for typing.
 - A single laptop, with Zoom in a small window on one side and the browser on the other. It works; it is just tighter.
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4. Bring three of your own past emails (required for the Writer block)

At 9:30 you teach the AI to write in your voice. It learns from your real writing, so:

1. Find three emails you wrote to clients. Any kind: a proposal, a confirmation, a welcome home. The more they sound like you, the better.
2. Copy the text of each into a plain document (Google Doc, Notes, Word, anything).
3. Delete the client's name, any booking or confirmation numbers, dates of birth, addresses, phone numbers, and anything about payment. Replace names with "the client." Keep everything else, especially how you open and close and the phrases you always use.
4. Have that document open on Saturday.

This takes about five minutes. If you skip it, you can use our sample emails on the day, but the voice you build will be ours, not yours.

5. Bring one real client scenario (required)

One trip you are working on or recently worked on. You will use it all morning. Write down, with no names:

- Who is traveling, in general terms (a couple in their sixties, a family of five, a group of eight friends)
- When, and for how long
- What they care about, and what they have told you they do not want
- Rough budget
- The actual question they asked you, if you remember it, or the quote you sent them

If you have nothing in flight, we have a sample scenario you can borrow. Yours will be more useful.

6. A notebook (recommended)

Paper or digital. You will want to write down which prompts you changed and why. Every prompt from the session is emailed to you Monday, so you do not need to copy them down during the morning.

7. Optional, not needed on Saturday

We mention these on Saturday. You do not need accounts for any of them, and none of them ask for a card:

- Gemini (gemini.google.com): Google's assistant, useful if you live in Gmail and Google Docs.
 - Perplexity (perplexity.ai): research answers with sources shown.
 - NotebookLM (notebooklm.google.com): ask questions of your own documents, such as a supplier brochure.
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8. The five minute "am I ready" test

Do this Friday evening.

1. Open the Zoom app. It opens without asking you to install anything. Audio test passes.
2. Open a browser tab. Go to chatgpt.com or claude.ai. You are already signed in; no login screen.

3. Type this into the chat box exactly:

In one sentence, what should I pack for Lisbon in October?

You get a reply within a few seconds.

4. Your stripped-email document opens and shows three emails with no client names in them.

5. Your client scenario is written down somewhere you can see it.

Five checks, five minutes. If any one fails, reply to this email and tell us which one, and we will sort it before Saturday.

What you do not need

- A paid plan for anything
- A credit card
- Any software besides Zoom and a browser
- Prior experience with AI. "I have never opened ChatGPT" is exactly who this session is for.

See you Saturday at 8:00 Eastern. The room opens at 7:50.